

Up close and personal

A film crew making a nature documentary captured footage of langur monkeys in Rajasthan, India, interacting with a robot camera disguised as a langur. A spy camera in its eye let it observe the monkeys closely.



MOVING MACHINES

ROBOT CAMERAS

Robots are machines programmed to carry out a series of actions on their own. They are often used for tasks that are repetitive, dangerous, or impossible for humans to do themselves, such as capturing useful footage of animals without disturbing them. Robots that mimic animals and plants are known as biomimetic robots. They are an ideal way to monitor wildlife, and allow scientists to learn more about animal behavior and social habits.



ROBOTS FOR THERAPY

Robots are increasingly playing an important role in health and social care. Seen here is Paro, a therapeutic robot resembling a baby harp seal. Its sensors detect touch and voices, and it wriggles and makes sounds in response. It has been proven to lift moods and reduce distress in patients and nursing home residents.